



GRETCHEN WHITMER
GOVERNOR

STATE OF MICHIGAN
DEPARTMENT OF
ENVIRONMENT, GREAT LAKES, AND ENERGY
WATER RESOURCES DIVISION



PHILLIP D. ROOS
DIRECTOR

August 19, 2025

CC No. CC-006510

VIA EMAIL

Patrick Miller
City of Cadillac
200 North Lake Street
Cadillac, Michigan 49601

Dear Patrick Miller:

SUBJECT: National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System (NPDES) Compliance
Evaluation Inspection (CEI)
Individual Permit No. MI0020257
Designated Name: Cadillac Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP)

On June 10, 2025, staff of the Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy (EGLE), Water Resources Division (WRD), conducted an NPDES CEI evaluation at the Cadillac Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP) (Facility) located at 1121 Plett Road, Cadillac, Wexford County, Michigan 49601. The purpose of the inspection was to evaluate the facility's compliance with NPDES Permit No. MI0020257.

You, Tom Asmus, Will Muzzi and I participated in the evaluation, which included a site tour, review of plant operations associated with NPDES compliance, records review, and laboratory review.

The following items were reviewed and/or discussed during the inspection, in addition to updating the CEI forms:

1. Current operational plan and status including staffing and hours of operation.
2. Ferric dosing location and efficiency.
3. Infrastructure maintenance and upgrades.
4. Laboratory staff, training and procedures.
5. 1 of 3 primary clarifiers turned into a sludge gravity thickening tank.
6. Status of 001 outfall.
7. DMRQA Study 44 results.
8. Reminder for non-compliance notifications when necessary.

The facility has made a temporary process modification including using 1 of the 3 primary clarifiers as a waste activated sludge gravity thickening tank. It is understood that this modification aims to improve sludge processing capabilities. Dependent on results from this temporary modification, if the facility decides to keep the waste activated sludge gravity thickening tank as part of their treatment process, EGLE WRD recommends that the facility installs a permanent piping system and perform any other necessary upgrades for

conversion of the primary clarifier to a permanent sludge thickening tank. Such upgrades would require a Part 41 permit for construction as well as an evaluation of the facility basis of design that demonstrates the remaining two primary clarifiers will meet unit process firm capacity and loading requirements with the third clarifier out of service for its intended use.

Once the evaluation was completed and all information was gathered, the following items were identified and should be addressed to comply with the facility's NPDES permit requirements:

1. Review of the sampling procedures showed that the following parameter listed below is not properly preserved. The NPDES permit requires that preservations are completed according to the requirements of 40 CFR Part 136, Guidelines Establishing Test Procedures for the Analysis of Pollutants (Part 136). Table II of Part 136 explains required preservation methods for each parameter. Please note that the preservation requirements stated in Table II take precedence over any other prescribed preservation techniques, container materials, or hold times as stated in the method or elsewhere. Failure to preserve samples as required by Part 136 is a violation of the NPDES Permit.
 - A. Table II of Part 136 requires ammonia samples to be immediately preserved with sulfuric acid. It was noted that the laboratory currently preserves ammonia samples only if the analysis is delayed.
2. Section 10 of the NPDES permit requires the facility to participate in the Environmental Protection Agency's yearly Discharge Monitoring Report – Quality Assurance (DMR-QA) Study Program. The purpose of the DMR-QA Study Program is to evaluate the proficiency of all in-house and/or contract laboratory(ies) that perform, on behalf of the facility authorized to discharge under this permit, the analytical testing required under this permit. Your results for the DMR-QA 44 study that was most recently completed showed approvable lab sample results. Although, your submission did not include a data report form, list of laboratories, or a signature as required, making this study incomplete and resulting in a violation of the NPDES permit.

In addition to the violations found during the inspection, since March 1, 2023, there are twelve (12) unaddressed effluent violations that have been reported to EGLE WRD through monthly DMRs, submitted via MiEnviro (formerly known as MiWaters). Of these twelve (12) effluent violations, 7 were violations of the maximum daily permit limitation for Carbonaceous Biochemical Oxygen Demand. Two (2) were violations of the maximum daily permit limitation for Ammonia Nitrogen. Two (2) were violations of the maximum monthly average permit limitation for Total Copper and Total Phosphorus and one (1) violation was generated when dissolved oxygen (DO) did not achieve its minimum daily average permit limitation.

MiEnviro also shows there are 8 unaddressed schedules of compliance violations dated back to March 6, 2023. Schedule of compliance violations are violations that auto generate in the

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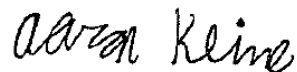
MiEnviro system when a submittal required by the NPDES permit is not received by its due date.

All effluent violations and schedule of compliance violations explained above are listed in Attachment 1. Although the effluent violations and schedule of compliance violations have ceased, the facility is required to maintain compliance with terms and conditions of the NPDES permit.

Please respond within 60 days to this letter with a Corrective Action Plan (CAP) including details on how and when correct preservation methods will be implemented for ammonia samples. Additionally, the CAP should include confirmation that all required information will be submitted with the next DMR-QA study explained in #2.

Thank you for your cooperation in these matters. Should you require further information, please contact me at Aaron Kline; KlineA4@Michigan.gov; or EGLE, WRD, Cadillac District Office, P.O. Box 30458, Lansing, Michigan 48909-7958.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Aaron Kline". The signature is written in a cursive, slightly slanted style.

Aaron Kline
Cadillac District Office
Water Resources Division

ak/sh
Attachment